Righteous Sufferer (*Ludlul bēl nēmeqi*) – Standard Babylonian IV: “He Drove Out Their Distress And Made Their Redness Well”

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- Translation: Benjamin R. Foster
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Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1

- **N:** itbuk | mānahtašin || r[u]ššašin | ušṭīb
- **T:** He drove out their distress and made their redness well.
- **L:** *itbuk* ← tabāku I “to pour (out)”; *mānahtašin* ← mānahtu I “MA pl. also *mānehātu* weariness, fatigue”; *r[u]ššašin* ← ruššû I, -šina I “red Bab. of gold, sun, bronze”; *ušṭīb* ← ṭiābu I “to be(come) good”
- **Note:** Previous line number d+1. For the new line numbers for chapter III, see [fromebllab0052: 123-124, 130-131].

```
NinNACom1 r 23–24. !bs it–bu–uk ma–na#–[a]h–ta–šin# r[u–u]š–ša₂–šin uš#–ṭib | ($
BabNBQuo1 r 9'. [x x x x x x x x x x x u]š–ṭi–ib
```

a+1

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]
- **Note:** Previous line numbers as section e (e+1-12)

```
SipNB1 o 1'. [x] x ma ṣi# x [...]
```

a+2

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
SipNB1 o 2'. [x] kal# gi# ma# ri/ur x [...]
```

a+3

- **N:** birkāya | ša uktassâ || būṣi[š | ubbuṭ]ā
- **T:** My knees, which were trussed and b[ound] like a partridge,
- **L:** *birkāya* ← birku I, -ya I “knee Bab.”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *uktassâ* ← kasû III “to bind”; *būṣi[š* ← būṣu I, -iš I “hyaena O/jB, NA”; *ubbuṭ]ā* ← ebēṭu II “~ to bind?”
- **Parallels:** cf. F 1879,0708.168 o 15'

```
SipNB1 o 3'. [bi]r–ka#–a–a# ša₂ uk–ta–[as–sa–a x x x x x x x]
NinNACom1 r 25. !bs bir–ka–a–a ša₂ uk#–tas–sa–a bu–ṣi–i[š* ub–bu–ṭ]a : !cm bu–ṣi
```

a+4

- **N:** […] … | purīdu || … […]
- **T:** [He …] … leg … […].
- **L:** *purīdu* ← purīdu I “MA pl. f. leg Bab., M/NA”

```
SipNB1 o 4'. [x x] x pu-ri-du k[i? ...]
```

a+5

- **N:** [šē]pāya | ša innamû || […]
- **T:** My feet, which had given out, […]
- **L:** *[šē]pāya* ← šēpu I, -ya I “f., often du.”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *innamû* ← nawû II “to turn into desert”

```
SipNB1 o 5'. [GI]R₃+MIN-a-a ša₂# in-na-mu#-u [...]
```

a+6

- **N:** [d]unnī | … || […]
- **T:** My energy, … […]
- **L:** *[d]unnī* ← dunnu I, -ī I

```
SipNB1 o 6'. [d]u-un-ni# qa-ru?#-u₂?# [...]
```

---

a+7

- **N:** šuklulti (|) pagrīya || … […] …
- **T:** The shape of my bo[d]y [he made] *extraordinary*,
- **L:** *šuklulti* ← šuklultu I “completion”; *pagrīya* ← pagru I, -ya I “pl. *pagrū*, jB also f., NB also *pagrānu* body”

```
SipNB1 o 7'. [šu]k-lul#-ti# pag-ri-i[a ...]
NinNACom1 r 26. !bs šuk-lul-tu₄ pag-ri#-ia# iš-ta-at-x [x (x)-š]u? : !cm šuk-lul
```

a+8

- **N:** [me]šrêtīya | […]
- **T:** My limbs […]
- **L:** *[me]šrêtīya* ← mešrêtu I, -ya I “pl. tant. limbs M/NB”

```
SipNB1 o 8'. [me]š-re-ti-ia [...]
```

a+9

- **N:** u minâtīya | […]
- **T:** My physique […]
- **L:** *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *minâtīya* ← minītu I, -ya I “measure, dimension Bab., NA”

```
SipNB1 o 9'. u₃# mi-na-ti-ia# [...]
```

---

a+10

- **N:** [i]hlup? | kīma ṣe[rri || …]
- **T:** […] *slipped out* like a snake […]
- **L:** *[i]hlup?* ← halāpu I “to slip into, through Bab., NA”; *kīma* ← kīma I “like”; *ṣe[rri* ← ṣerru I “snake in similes”

```
SipNB1 o 10'. [i]h?-lu-up ki-ma ṣe[r-ri ...]
```

a+11

- **N:** [(…)] … […]
- **T:** [(…)] … […]

```
SipNB1 o 11'. [(x)] x-ṣi ša₂ ši?#-r[i?-...]
```

a+12

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
SipNB1 o 12'. [x] x x x [...]
```

a+13

- **N:** […] … […]

```
BabLBSch1 o 3'. [x x x (x)] x x [(x)] x [x x x (x)]
```

a+14

- **N:** […] … […]

```
BabLBSch1 o 4'. [x x x x] x [x x x x (x)]
```

a+15

- **N:** [(…)] … k[īl]i ṣētu … […]
- **L:** *k[īl]i* ← kīlu I “enclosure, confinement M/NB of prisoner”; *ṣētu* ← ṣītu I “pl. *cf. ṣiātu* exit”

```
BabLBSch1 o 5'. [(x)] x x k[i-l]i ṣe-e-[t]u₄ i?#-x [x x (x x)]
```

a+16

- **N:** [e]kle[t]u iškun[a a]na [n]a[mirti?]
- **L:** *[e]kle[t]u* ← ekletu I “(or *iklētu(m)*) darkness Bab.”; *iškun[a* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”; *a]na* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”; *[n]a[mirti?]* ← nawirtu I “brightness, light O/jB *n. šakānu* to bring about brightness”

```
BabLBSch1 o 6'. [e]k-le-[t]u₄ iš#-ku#-n[a a]-na# [n]a-[mir?-ti?]
```

a+17

- **N:** [u]špardi eṭûti [šamši] … […]
- **L:** *[u]špardi* ← napardû II “to shine brightly M/NB, NA”; *eṭûti* ← eṭûtu I “darkness M/NB, NA esp. *ana e.* into darkness”; *[šamši]* ← šamšu I “OB occas. f. sun”

```
BabLBSch1 o 7'. [u]š-par-di# e-ṭu#-ti [x x x] i?#-ri-[x (x)]
```

a+18

- **N:** akla simat nišī u[ṭīb] eli pîy[a]
- **L:** *akla* ← akalu I; *simat* ← simtu I “appropriate symbol, characteristic before abstr. nouns symbol, proper…”; *nišī* ← nišu I “mostly pl. *nišū*”; *u[ṭīb]* ← ṭiābu I “to be(come) good”; *eli* ← eli I “on, over, above”; *pîy[a]* ← pû I, -ya I “(also OB)”

```
BabLBSch1 o 8'. ak-lu si#-mat UN-MEŠ u₂#-[ṭib] UGU# KA-i[a]
```

a+19

- **N:** udaššip eli šaptīya [lall]ariš …
- **L:** *udaššip* ← dašāpu I “to be sweet O/jB”; *eli* ← eli I “on, over, above”; *šaptīya* ← šaptu I, -ya I “f.”; *[lall]ariš* ← lallāriš I “like honey jB”

```
BabLBSch1 o 9'. u₂-da-[a]š₂-ši-ip# UGU# šap#-ti#-ia [lal-l]a-riš# na rat/hu an?#
```

---

a+20

- **N:** imšuš | mammê || ruššûš | uzakki
- **T:** He wiped off the grime, he cleared up its redness
- **L:** *imšuš* ← mašāšu I “to wipe off”; *mammê* ← mammû I “frost, ice O/jB”; *ruššûš* ← ruššû I “red Bab. of gold, sun, bronze”
- **Note:** Previous line number f+1.

```
NinNACom1 r 27–28. !bs im–šu–uš °\ma°–am–me₂–e r[u–š]u–uš u₂–zak–ki | ($___$) !cr
BabLBSch1 o 10'. [i]m–š[u–u]š ma#–am#–m[e₂–e ru–uš?]–ša₂–šu u₂–zak#–ki#
```

a+21

- **N:** [uša]nbiṭ [šuhtī] kīma siparri
- **L:** *[uša]nbiṭ* ← nabāṭu I “to be(come) bright, shine Bab.”; *[šuhtī]* ← šuhtu I “verdigris, patina, rust O/jB, NA on copper sword”; *kīma* ← kīma I “like”; *siparri* ← siparru I “? bronze”

```
BabLBSch1 o 11'. [u₂–ša₂]–an–biṭ# [x x x] GIM# si#–par#–ri
```

a+22

- **N:** […]

a+23

- **N:** […] … […] … [u]bbi[ba]nni
- **L:** *[u]bbi[ba]nni* ← ebēbu I, -am I, -ni II “to be(come) bright, pure”

```
BabLBSch1 o 12'. [(x) x] x [x (x)] x [u]b–bi#–i[b?–a]n–ni
```

---

a+30

- **N:** dūtī | ummultu | ittapardi
- **T:** My flustered mien began to glow
- **L:** *dūtī* ← dūtu I, -ī I “virility, manliness O/jB”; *ummultu* ← ummulu I “jB”; *ittapardi* ← napardû II “to shine brightly M/NB, NA”
- **Note:** Previous line number g+1.

```
NinNACom1 r 29. !bs du–u₂–tu₄ um–mul–tu₄ it–ta–par–di : !cm du–u₂–tu : bu–un–na–
```

---

b+1

- **N:** ina itê (|) nāri || ašar dīn (|) nišī | ibberru
- **T:** At the place of the river ordeal, where people's fates are decided
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on"; *itê* ← itû I "pl. m. & f. boundary"; *nāri* ← nāru I "f., NA m. river, watercourse, canal"; *ašar* ← ašru III "pl. m. & f., place, site"; *dīn* ← dīnu I "pl. m. & f. legal decision"; *nišī* ← nišu I "mostly pl. *nišū*"; *ibberru* ← bêru I "to choose, select"
- **Note:** Previous line number h+1.

```
NinNACom1 r 30-31. !bs i-na i-te-e {d}ID₂ a-šar de-en UN-MEŠ ib-ber-ru | ($___$)
```

---

c+1

- **N:** [...] ... [...]
- **T:** [...] ... [...]
- **Note:** Previous line numbers as section i (i+1-17).

```
NinNA1 1'. [x x x x (x x)] x (x x) [x x (x x)]
```

c+2

- **N:** [...] ... [...]
- **T:** [...] ... [...]

```
NinNA1 2'. [x x x (x x) š]a₂ kil [x x (x x)]
```

c+3

- **N:** [...] ... [...]
- **T:** [...] ... [...]

```
NinNA1 3'. [x x x (x)] x-MEŠ# [x x (x x)]
```

c+4

- **N:** [...] | ellūtu || ... [...]
- **T:** [...] *pure* [...]
- **L:** *ellūtu* ← ellu I "pure"

```
NinNA1 4'. [x x x (x)] KU₃-MEŠ e-n[i-x (x x)]
```

c+5

- **N:** [… | il]kunu || šunu | … […]
- **T:** […] your god, they … […]
- **L:** *il]kunu* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *šunu* ← šunu I “before subjunct. *-(u)ni*”

```
NinNA1 5'. [x x (x) DINGIR]-MEŠ*#-ku#-nu šu-nu šin-x [x (x x)]
```

c+6

- **N:** […] | ištarkunu || kilallān | […]
- **T:** […] your goddess, both […]
- **L:** *ištarkunu* ← ištaru I, -kunu I “pl. *ištarātum*, *ištarū*, *ištarānu* goddess Bab. *ilu(m) u i.* god…”; *kilallān* ← kilallān I “f. *kilattān*, OA also *kilaltān*, OB gen. *kilettīn* both of…”

```
NinNA1 6'. [x x (x) {d}i]š-tar#-ku#-nu ki-lal-la-an [x x (x x)]
BabNBSch1 o 10. [x x (x)] {d#}15-ku-nu ki-lal-la-an [x x (x x)]
```

c+7

- **N:** [… | u]nnāna || šumruṣa | … […]
- **T:** […] supplication, the most painful […]
- **L:** *u]nnāna* ← unnīnu I “supplication, petition OAkk, Bab., NA *u. leqû(m)* of deity, king…”; *šumruṣa* ← marāṣu I “to be(come) ill”

```
NinNA1 7'. [x x (x) un-n]a-an-na šum-ru-ṣa x [x (x x)]
BabNBSch1 o 11. [x x (x) u]n-na-an-na šum#-ru#-ṣ[u x x (x x)]
```

c+8

- **N:** […] … | bulluṭu || šakin | … […]
- **T:** […] reviving, […] was placed
- **L:** *bulluṭu* ← balāṭu II “to live”; *šakin* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”

```
NinNA1 8'. [x x (x)] x-šu₂ bul-lu-ṭu ša₂-kin x [x (x x)]
BabNBSch1 o 12. [x x (x x)] bul?#-lu?#-[ṭu x x x x (x x)]
```

c+9

- **N:** [(…) uball]iṭanni | šēress[u | …]
- **T:** […he rev]ived me, […] his punishment
- **L:** *uball]iṭanni* ← balāṭu II, -am I, -ni II “to live”; *šēress[u* ← šērtu I, -šu I “guilt, crime”

```
NinNA1 9'. [(x x) u₂-bal-l]i-ṭan-ni še-ret-s[u x x (x x)]
```

---

c+10

- **N:** muttata | ammašid || abbutta | appaš[ir]
- **T:** I was stroked on the forehead, I was relieved of my slave mark.
- **L:** *muttata* ← muttatu I “half of parts of the body etc.”; *ammašid* ← mašādu I “to beat”; *abbutta* ← abbuttu I “(a hair-style) O/jB, Nuzi as mark of slavery”; *appaš[ir]* ← pašāru I “to release, free”

```
NinNA1 10'. [x x x am]-ma-šid ab-bu-ut-t[a x x x]
NinNACom1 r 32. !bs mut#-tu#-tu# am#-ma#-šid# ab#-bu#-ut#-tu₄# ap#-pa#-š[ir : !c
```

c+11

- **N:** [… | all]abiš? || eri[nna? | …]
- **T:** […] …, the *neck*-[*stock * …]
- **L:** *all]abiš?* ← labāšu I “to clothe o.s.”; *eri[nna?* ← erinnu I “neck-stock, halter jB for prisoner”

```
NinNA1 11'. [x x x (x) al?-l]a-biš e-ri-i[n?-na? x x (x)]
```

c+12

- **N:** […] … | šibbu? | […]
- **T:** […] … […]
- **L:** *šibbu?* ← šibbu I “belt Bab. (sword-)belt”

```
NinNA1 12'. [x x x (x)] me šib-bu [x x x (x x)]
```

c+13

- **N:** […] … | qadāda | […]
- **T:** […] bent over […]
- **L:** *qadāda* ← qadādu I “to bow down OAkk, Bab.”

```
NinNA1 13'. [x x x (x)] x qa-da-da# [x x x (x x)]
```

c+14

- **N:** […] … || šig[û | …]
- **T:** […] a song of sorrow […]

- **L:** *šig[û* ← šigû I "(a cry of lamentation) Bab. *š. šasû*"
- **Note:** This line must comment on one of the lines between i+11' and i+15' but no identification is possible. The suggestion of J. Oelsner to understand *rēmu* as an explanation for *šigû* and thus attaching this line to i+14' (and/or i+15') seems plausible (see [RN2243dd: 28 fn 17]).

```
NinNA1 14'. [x x x (x)] x x ši-g[u-u₂ x x (x x)]
NinNACom1 r 35. !bs [...] x [x x x] :# !cm re#-e#-mu#
```

c+15

- **N:** [...] ... || šig[û | ...]
- **T:** [...] a song of sorrow [...]
- **L:** *šig[û* ← šigû I "(a cry of lamentation) Bab. *š. šasû*"

```
NinNA1 15'. [x x x (x)] x x-ia# ši-g[u-u₂ x x (x x)]
```

c+16

- **N:** [kunuš-k]adru | ina pišerti | abā'
- **T:** I proceeded along [Kunush-k]adru Street in a state of redemption.
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on"; *pišerti* ← pišertu I "release O/jB"; *abā'* ← bâ'u I "to go along Bab., OA"

```
NinNA1 16'. [ku-nu-uš-kad₃-r]u? ina pi-š[er₃-ti x x x]
NinNACom1 r 36-37. !bs [ku-nu-uš-k]ad₃-ru# i-na pi-šer₃#-ti# a-ba-' | ($___$) !c
```

c+17

- **N:** [...] ... [...]
- **T:** [...] ... [...]

```
NinNA1 17'. [x x x (x x)] u₂?# x [x x x x (x x x)]
```

---

d+1

- **N:** ana zarp[ānītu | ...]
- **T:** To Zarp[anitu ...]
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š...* etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n...*"; *zarp[ānītu* ← Zarpānītu I "(or *ṣarpānītu(m)*) (a goddess, wife of Marduk) Bab., NA"
- **Note:** Previous line numbers as section j (j+1-10).

```
NinNA2 r? 1'. a#-na# {d#}zar#-p[a-ni-tu₄ ...]
```

d+2

- **N:** ana ilīy[a | ...]
- **T:** To my god [...]
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ilīy[a* ← ilu I, -ya I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”

```
NinNA2 r? 2'. a-na DINGIR-M[U ...]
```

d+3

- **N:** ana ištarīy[a | ...]
- **T:** To my goddess [...]
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ištarīy[a* ← ištaru I “pl. *ištarātum*, *ištarū*, *ištarānu* goddess Bab. *ilu(m) u i.* god...”

```
NinNA2 r? 3'. a-na {d}15-M[U ...]
```

---

d+4

- **N:** lā pālih (|) i[līšu || ...]
- **T:** The one who does not revere [his] god [...]
- **L:** *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pālih* ← palāhu I “to fear, revere”; *i[līšu* ← ilu I, -šu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”

```
NinNA2 r? 4'. la pa-li-ih D[INGIR-šu₂ ...]
```

d+5

- **N:** lā pālih (|) [ištarīšu || ...]
- **T:** The one who does not revere [his goddess ...]
- **L:** *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pālih* ← palāhu I “to fear, revere”; *[ištarīšu* ← ištaru I, -šu I “pl. *ištarātum*, *ištarū*, *ištarānu* goddess Bab. *ilu(m) u i.* god...”

```
NinNA2 r? 5'. la pa-li-ih {d#}[15-šu₂ ...]
```

d+6

- **N:** ša ana esagil | īgû || ina qātīya | līmur

- **T:** He who has done wrong by Esagil, let him learn from me,
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *esagil* ← Esaggil I; *īgû* ← egû III “to be(come) lazy”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *qātīya* ← qātu I, -ya I “f.”; *līmur* ← amāru I “to see”

```
NinNA2 r? 6'. ša₂ a-na e₂-sag-i[l₂ ...]
NinNACom1 r 38. !bs [ša₂] a#-na e₂-sag-il₂ e-gu-u ina ŠU-ia li-mur : !cm e-gu-u
```

d+7

- **N:** ša amāt (|) bābili | [...]
- **T:** He who has [...] the word of Babylon [...]
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *amāt* ← awātu I “word”; *bābili* ← Babili I

```
NinNA2 r? 7'. ša₂ a-mat KA₂.DINGIR.RA{k[i} ...]
```

---

d+8

- **N:** marušta | epšēk[u || ...]
- **T:** The suffering [I] was made to undergo [...]
- **L:** *marušta* ← maruṣtu I “evil, distress *m. amāru* to experience trouble”; *epšēk[u* ← epēšu II “to do”

```
NinNA2 r? 8'. ma-ru-uš#-tu₂# ep#-še-k[u? ...]
```

d+9

- **N:** šēre[t ...]
- **T:** The punishment [...]
- **L:** *šēre[t* ← šērtu I “guilt, crime”

```
NinNA2 r? 9'. še-re[t ...]
```

d+10

- **N:** ... [...]
- **T:** [...] ... [...]

```
NinNA2 r? 10'. x [...]
```